INTERIM AMENDMENT
TO
FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

KNIVES; GENERAL PURPOSE SHOP, DETACHABLE BLADE

This interim amendment was developed by the General Services Administration, Federal Supply Service, Washington, DC 20406, based upon currently available technical information. It is recommended that Federal agencies use it in procurement and forward recommendations for changes to the preparing activity at the address shown above.

The General Services Administration has authorized the use of this interim amendment as a valid exception to Federal Specification GGC-K-494B, dated April 10, 1974.

PAGE 2

Paragraph 3.4, delete and substitute:

3.4 Handles. Handles shall be well constructed, well balanced, and provide a comfortable handgrip. Handles shall be free from burrs, sharp edges, or other defects which might cause injury or discomfort to the user. Handle design shall provide the user adequate protection for both safely retaining and positioning the cutting blade during usage of the knife. The handle shall comply with tests in 4.5.1.

3.4.1 *Handle storage compartment. A safe and easily accessible storage compartment shall be* provided in the handle for storing five blades. This storage compartment shall be designed to enclose, position, and secure the five extra blades and prevent those blades from sliding, rotating or coming out of position during even the roughest usage of the knife.

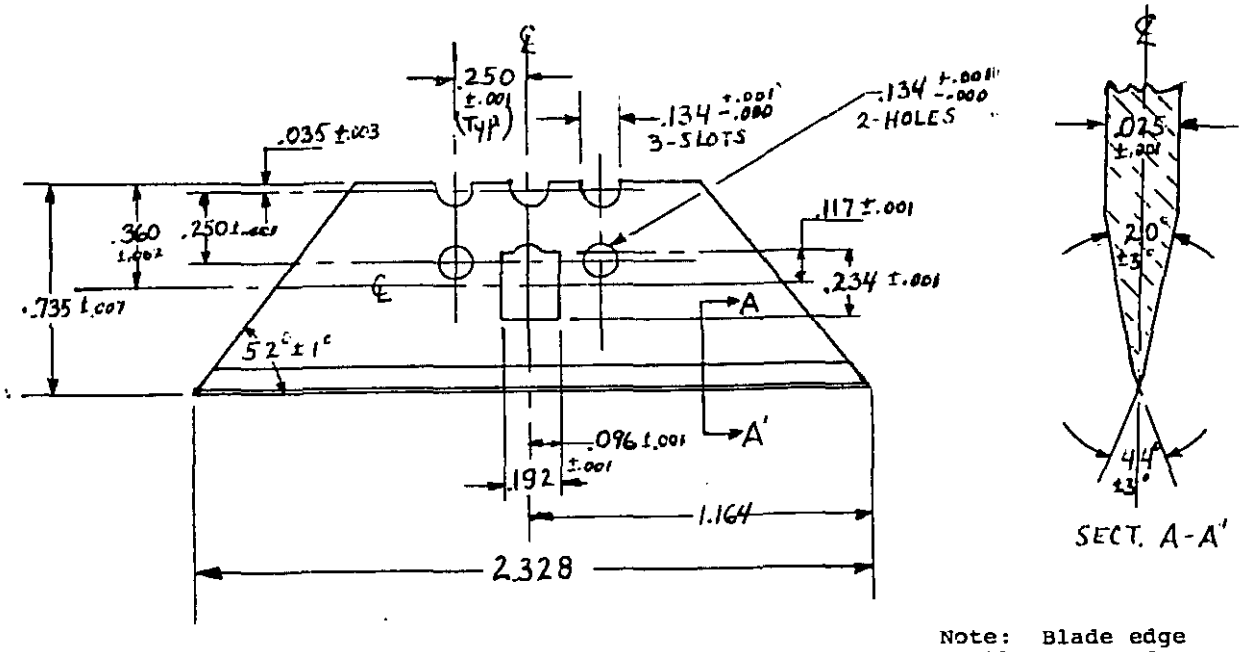
PAGE 3

Paragraph 3.6, delete and substitute:

3.6 Blades. The blades shall be of high carbon steel conforming to QQ-S-700 steel number SAE 1095. The blades shall be hardened, tempered, and ground. The Rockwell hardness of the blades shall be not less than the equivalent of 50 nor more than 64 on the C scale when tested as specified in 4.5.2. Five blades shall be furnished with each knife, and these (5) plus all replacement blades shall conform to the standard configuration and dimensions of figure 3.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T12:40Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

PAGE 3 (con.)



Note: Unless otherwise specified, tolerances ±.005 inch.

Note: Blade edge shall be ground smooth and sharp.

FIGURE 3. Standard blade.

Paragraph 3.8, delete and substitute:

3.8 Screw threads. All threads shall conform to H28 as to shape and form of threads. The head of the screw that joins the two halves of the handle together shall be countersunk below the surface of the handle half, and shall engage at least four full threads in the other handle half. Self-tapping screws are not acceptable.

PAGE 4

Paragraph 4.5.1, delete and substitute:

4.5.1 Drop test. The complete knife with the five blades in the storage compartment shall be dropped on concrete at least three times from a height of at least 6 feet. There shall be no evidence of any handle separation cracks, breaks, or malfunctioning parts. Next, the screw holding the handle halves together shall be removed, and the five blades in the storage compartment shall be examined. If any of the five blades is missing or out of position (not completely confined within the storage compartment) the knife shall have failed this test.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T12:40Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.